



Showing context in the status line

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Showing Context in the Status Line

Claude Code doesn't show your [context window](#) usage by default. You need to set this up yourself if you want to monitor it constantly while you're coding.

Having that number right in your status line, visible at a glance, gives you the feedback you need to make good decisions about your [session](#). We'll use [ccstatusline](#), a community tool that formats Claude Code's session data into a clean status line.

Steps To Complete

Configure ccstatusline

- ☐ Create the config directory

```
mkdir -p ~/.config/ccstatusline
```

- ☐ Create [~/.config/ccstatusline/settings.json](#) with this content:

```
{
  "version": 3,
  "lines": [
    [
      {
        "id": "1",
        "type": "context-length",
        "color": "yellow",
        "bold": true,
        "rawValue": true
      },
      {
        "id": "2",
        "type": "custom-text",
        "customText": "(",
        "color": "brightBlack",
        "merge": "no-padding"
      },
      {
        "id": "3",
        "type": "context-percentage",
        "color": "brightBlack",
        "rawValue": true,
        "merge": "no-padding"
      },
      {
        "id": "4",
        "type": "custom-text",
        "customText": ")",
        "color": "brightBlack",
        "merge": "no-padding"
      }
    ],
    [],
    []
  ],
  "flexMode": "full-minus-40",
  "compactThreshold": 60,
  "colorLevel": 2,
  "defaultSeparator": " ",
  "inheritSeparatorColors": false,
  "globalBold": false,
  "powerline": {
    "enabled": false,
    "separators": [" "],
    "separatorInvertBackground": [false],
    "startCaps": [],
    "endCaps": [],
    "autoAlign": false
  }
}
```

This configures four widgets on one line: a bold yellow [token](#) count ([context-length](#)), followed by a dimmed percentage in parentheses. The ["merge": "no-padding"](#) on the parentheses and percentage widgets glues them together without extra spacing, while ["defaultSeparator": " "](#) adds a space between the token count and the opening parenthesis. ["rawValue": true](#) strips the labels so you get clean numbers.

Update Claude Code Settings

- ☐ Open [~/.claude/settings.json](#)

If this file doesn't exist yet, create it.

- ☐ Add the status line configuration

```
{
  "statusLine": {
    "type": "command",
    "command": "npx ccstatusline@latest"
  }
}
```

Preserve any other settings that might already exist in this file. Claude Code pipes session data to this command automatically - [ccstatusline](#) reads it and outputs the formatted status line.

Test Your Setup

- ☐ Restart Claude Code completely

Close the application fully and reopen it.

- ☐ Check your status line

You should now see a bold yellow token count followed by a dimmed percentage (like [186.2k \(17.3%\)](#)) displayed in your Claude Code status line. These numbers update as your context window fills during your session.

Credits

aihero.dev (Matt Pocock).

